

Chloe Hayden and the Lost Fairy Tales: The Sidekick System

System Philosophy: "Different, Not Less"

The **Sidekick System** is a core gameplay mechanic that mirrors the central theme of Chloe Hayden's work: that every protagonist needs support and that specific challenges are only surmountable through the help of others. In this game, Chloe's progress is directly tied to her ability to rescue and collaborate with the inhabitants of various fairy tale worlds.

This system reinforces the idea that finding one's "tribe" or "sidekicks" is a vital part of finding a "Happily Ever After".

The Neverland Hub (Lobby)

Neverland serves as the central hub where all rescued fairy tale characters migrate. Once a character is saved from the Shadow's influence at the end of a world, they become available for selection in the Lobby menu before embarking on a new stage.

Equipping Sidekicks

- **The Companion Slot:** Before entering any of the 5 main worlds, the player must select one active Sidekick in the Lobby.
- **Progressive Unlock:** Characters are only available once their specific World Boss (Shadow form) has been defeated.

Sidekick Abilities and Effects

Each Sidekick provides a unique mechanical advantage that allows Chloe to interact with the environment in ways her base form cannot, specifically designed to uncover **Collectible Extras** and hidden **Lost Pages**.

Sidekick	Origin World	Ability / Effect	Level Secret Utility
Peter Pan	World 1: Neverland ▾	Eternal Flight: Allows Chloe to hover or fly for short durations.	Reaching floating pages and high-altitude platforms.
Alice	World 3: The Dreame... ▾	Size Shifting: Enables Chloe to become tiny to enter small tunnels or grow large to break obstacles.	Accessing "rabbit hole" tunnels and hidden micro-rooms.
The Genie	World 4: The Lovers ▾	Wishful Liberation: Grants temporary invulnerability or phase-shifting through "trap" barriers.	Passing through solid Shadow-walls that gate secret items.
Simba	World 5: The Courag... ▾	Royal Roar: Stuns Shadow enemies and activates sound-sensitive environmental triggers.	Opening ancient stone doors locked by acoustic puzzles.
Mulan	World 5: The Courag... ▾	Precision Strike: Enhances the Bow and Arrow mechanic for long-range environmental interaction.	Triggering switches that are out of standard reach.

Level Design and Secrets

Stages are designed with non-linear paths that encourage re-visiting previous worlds once new Sidekicks are unlocked.

- **Ability Gates:** Certain sections of a level will be visually marked with symbols corresponding to a specific Sidekick's power (e.g., a small door for Alice, a high ledge for Peter).
- **Collectible Synergies:** While a stage can be completed with Chloe's base mechanics to achieve a **Neutral Ending**, the **Good Ending** requires 100% collection of pages and items, which is impossible without strategically using Sidekicks to find every hidden corner.
- **The Hub Evolution:** As more Sidekicks are equipped and used, the Neverland Hub itself transforms, with the characters sharing inspirational quotes from *Different, Not Less* as loading screen text or idle dialogue.

Character Progression

As Chloe moves through worlds like **The Princesses** or **The Lovers**, the sidekicks don't just provide mechanics; they represent the "tribe" that Chloe lacked in her early story. Rescuing these characters populates the **Autistic Sanctuary** extra, creating a safe space within the game that reflects the player's progress in restoring the Supreme Book of Fairy Tales.